Nothing to exit 12 markets

Despite India growth, global shipment declines

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Nothing was India's fastest-growing smartphone brand in Q2 2026, posting 105% year-on-year growth according to Counterpoint Research, driven by the Phone (4a) series and the title sponsorship of Royal Challengers Bengaluru during IPL 2026. The numbers are real, but incomplete.

Digit has learned from multiple sources that Nothing is simultaneously contracting its global footprint, cutting headcount and managing internal financial strain. Things are so dire that they are planning to exit from a dozen countries over the next few weeks.

Nothing's global picture

According to information Digit has independently confirmed, Nothing is in the process of shutting down in 12 or more global markets. The exits include the Middle East, Japan and parts of Europe. In addition, global headcount is being reduced by 40% and their R&D unit, which is split 70:30 between China and London, is facing layoffs of around 50% and 30-40% respectively.

The Phone (4b) has shipped approximately 20,000 units globally since launch, while the Phone (4a) and Phone (4a) Pro have together reached around 150,000 units. Nothing sold approximately 2 million units globally in 2025 but sustaining that in 2026 is harder as memory prices have risen almost four times since September 2025 and the resulting price hikes have weakened consumer demand across the board. Global shipment volumes are under strain and in a market where the mass segment has effectively collapsed, brands operating at lower price points are feeling it most.

A brand without a phone

CMF, Nothing's sub-brand built around devices priced under Rs 30,000, has no new smartphone planned for 2026. Nothing co-founder Akis Evangelidis confirmed this publicly saying, "We were working on a successor, but with memory prices where they are right now, we can't build a phone that feels like a genuine step forward at a price that makes sense for CMF."

CMF's identity was built on delivering well-designed, feature-rich hardware in the sub-Rs 20,000 bracket, a segment Counterpoint says fell 45% year on year in Q2 2026 alone. The economics of that segment have been broken by memory costs. As such, CMF cannot price a successor where it needs to be without either gutting the specification or absorbing losses it cannot absorb. The result is that at least one device planned for CMF has moved to the Nothing brand, where a higher price point is more defensible. But it leaves CMF without a hero product for the foreseeable future.

Himanshu Tandon, the executive who built CMF into one of the challenger brands in the budget segment, has stepped down. His exit just adds to CMF's woes with the product freeze.

The India-global gap

Nothing's 105% growth figure excludes CMF, which spun off as a separate entity in 2025. The growth is Nothing the brand alone, concentrated primarily in the Phone (4a) series. That is still a very small volume for a brand competing in India's mid-range segment as opposed to a global backdrop where shipment totals are declining alongside the broader market.

Nothing has so far navigated this environment better than most in India, benefiting from the premium perception of its hardware, the RCB association and a loyal user base. d

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